

1971

INDIA A

THUMPING WINS



<< REWIND

In one fell swoop, India's image changed from peace to power. The Fifth Lok Sabha elections saw the Congress bagging 350 of the 518 seats polled, but it wasn't the only victory in the year. India supported East Pakistan's struggle for independence—as Indira Gandhi told the National Press Club in Washington, this was not a “civil war” but “a genocidal punishment of civilians for having voted democratically”. The third Indo-Pakistan war broke out on December 3, but 11 days later the Pakistani army was forced to surrender in East Pakistan and India recognised the People's Republic of Bangladesh.



TASTE OF VICTORY:
General Niazi (centre)
surrenders to Lt-Gen
Jagjit Singh Aurora (left)

FIRST CUT

- Himachal Pradesh, a Union Territory since 1950, was formally declared a state on January 25 under the Himachal Pradesh Act, 1971.
- Air India's first jumbo jet plane

Boeing 747, named *Emperor Ashoka*, landed at Bombay.

- Just prior to the Indo-Pakistan war, an Indian Airlines Fokker Friendship aircraft, *Ganga*, was hijacked on its way to Lahore and destroyed by the hijackers.

<< DID YOU KNOW

Before Parliament abolished the privy purses of the princes, proclaiming them to be normal citizens, annual benefits to the 278 princes ran into several crores, with the highest amount of \$3,50,000 paid to the Maharaja of Mysore.